TOWNSHIP CASE STUDY

Helicopter Orders & Flexible Orders

The question

When is an order worth completing?

Helicopter orders trade goods for coins and XP. Complete an order or delete it and wait for a replacement.

Township

An order gives production a purpose. Its value depends on the player’s goal and available goods.

Public rules support this case. Player frustrations and benefits are hypotheses to test.

Helicopter orders

Player choices

Complete

Deliver goods for coins and XP.

Delete

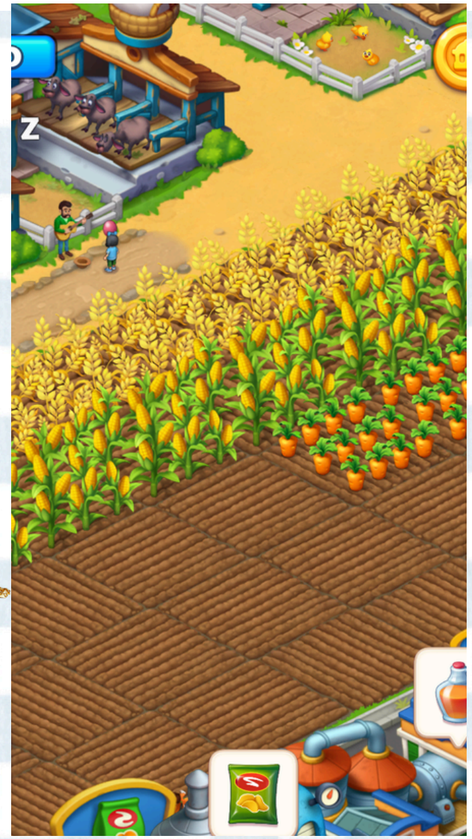
Wait for a replacement order.

Spend

Buy missing goods with T-Cash.

Order loop

Orders connect production to town progress. Each delivery uses goods another shipment may need.



Produce

Choose

Deliver

Progress

The trade-off

Helicopter: spend goods to earn coins and XP now.

Hypothetical example

Both orders need your last two cheeses. The helicopter offers coins now. The train returns building materials. Your next town goal determines which is more useful.

Opportunity cost: choosing one reward delays the other.

Train: save the same goods for construction materials.

Flexible Orders

Option A
3 breads +
2 cheeses
Keep your
cream.

Option B
3 breads +
4 creams
Keep your
cheese.

Town picnic delivery

Compare options, collect goods, then send. Quantities are illustrative.

Concept

Selected ordinary orders offer two alternatives for one item.

Both options show rewards upfront and stay fixed until delivery or deletion.

Players choose which goods to spend. Proposed feature.

Rules & balance

Design rules

Start with a small share of ordinary orders. Keep special orders unchanged.

Balance production time, ingredients and factory upgrades.

If one option dominates, revise requirements or rewards.

Clear choice

Show goods and rewards before the player commits.

Fixed options

No free rerolls. Both recipes stay with the order.

Fair cost

Match production effort. Avoid one obvious best recipe.

A/B test

PRIMARY METRIC

24-hour order completion rate

Ordinary orders completed within 24 hours ÷ ordinary orders first displayed to eligible players.

Count each order once. Use only orders with a full 24-hour observation window.

Test setup

Randomise eligible players: existing orders vs Flexible Orders. Compare all ordinary orders in both groups.

DIAGNOSTICS

Recipe-choice share among completed Flexible Orders.
Median time to completion.

GUARDRAILS

Coins earned per active player per day.
Train shipments per active player per day.
Day-7 retention.

Decision: seek a primary-metric improvement without meaningful guardrail harm. Set thresholds and sample size before testing. No live-test results yet.

My role / Tools / Status

My role	Portfolio author. Gameplay observations, concept review and case-study editing.
Tools	Canva. ChatGPT/Codex for AI-assisted analysis and layout. PDF editing tools.
Status	Independent feature concept. No prototype or live A/B test completed.

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